ZAID PATHAN

Penetration Tester | Cybersecurity Analyst | Security Instructor
zaidkhan.252000@gmail.com | +91 78230 54701 | Nashik, Maharashtra | LinkedIn: Zaid Pathan

SUMMARY

NSD-Certified Penetration Tester with hands-on experience in web application security, offensive security assessments, and compliance-driven infrastructure hardening. Proven ability to identify critical vulnerabilities — including privilege escalation and broken access controls — and deliver clear, actionable remediation reports aligned with OWASP Top 10. Currently working as a cybersecurity instructor, translating real-world offensive techniques into structured, practical training for the next generation of security professionals.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Technical Instructor — Cybersecurity | *IRT Technologies Pvt Ltd* Feb 2025 – Present

- Designed and delivered **20+ lab modules** on Nmap, Nessus, Burp Suite, and OWASP Top 10 exploitation, reducing student onboarding time by an estimated **30%** over lecture-only formats.
- Mentored students through full penetration testing capstone projects — each covering reconnaissance, exploitation, and professional remediation reporting on simulated environments.
- Built a complete course library — slide decks, lab guides, assessments, and solution walkthroughs — reducing instructor prep time for future cohorts by **~40%**.
- Refreshed curriculum quarterly with new CVEs, emerging threat intelligence, and updated tooling to keep content current with the evolving threat landscape.

Technical Support Engineer | *WowinfoBiz Pvt Ltd* Oct 2024 – Feb 2025

- Hardened all endpoints to EUDR compliance baselines — deploying encryption standards, secure access policies, and log monitoring — achieving **zero audit findings** during the compliance review.
- Enforced **MFA across 100% of user accounts**, eliminating credential-only access as an attack vector.
- Patched critical and high-severity CVEs within SLA windows, maintaining a clean vulnerability backlog.
- Produced audit-ready documentation packages (ticket history, remediation evidence, configuration records) that passed external inspection on first submission.

KEY PROJECT

Black-Box Penetration Test — Postgraduate Portal
Sole tester. Full web application scope. Methodology: OWASP Testing Guide.

- **Escalated privilege from a student account to professor-level access** by exploiting broken access control — a critical finding that would have exposed all student records in production.
- Identified **5 critical/high vulnerabilities**: privilege escalation, session fixation, insecure file upload, server banner disclosure, and weak password hashing.
- Delivered an OWASP-aligned remediation report with severity ratings, proof-of-concept evidence, and fix guidance — enabling the dev team to resolve all critical issues within one sprint.
- Performed risk prioritization and business-impact analysis for each finding to support efficient stakeholder triage.

CERTIFICATIONS

NSD Certified Penetration Tester (NCPT)
Cyber Security Essentials — Linux Foundation (LCF108)
Networking Basics — Cisco

Ethical Hacker — Cisco
Junior Cybersecurity Analyst — Cisco

SKILLS

Offensive: Penetration Testing, VAPT, Burp Suite, Nmap, Nessus, Privilege Escalation, Exploit Development
Web Security: OWASP Top 10, Session Management, Input Validation, Access Control Testing
Networking: OSI Model, Routing, Switching, Subnetting, Network Scanning
Tools & Languages: Linux, Python, HTML, JavaScript, MFA Enforcement, Compliance (EUDR)

EDUCATION

B.Tech, Mechanical Engineering 2021 – 2024
DBATU University — Aurangabad College of Engineering | CGPA: 6.61

Diploma, Mechanical Engineering 2016 – 2021
MSBTE — JMCT Polytechnic, Nashik